

Christian Worship and Service

Lesson 21 Questions

First Day: Read the Lesson 20 Notes.

The notes and lecture fortify the truth of the passage for understanding and application to daily life.

1. How did the lecture impact your understanding or practice of worshipping God?

2. What truth from the notes encouraged you or strengthened your relationship with God?

Second Day: Read Romans 12:1-2.

Paul urged believers to offer God their bodies as living sacrifices.

3. What do you learn about God and His mercy from the following verses?

   Romans 9:15

   Romans 9:23

   Ephesians 2:4-5

   1 Peter 1:3

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4. Reflect on your study of Romans 1–8. How have you personally experienced God's mercy?

5. a. Compare and contrast the Old Testament animal sacrifices with the kind of sacrifice Paul urged Christians to offer. (See also Leviticus 16; Romans 6:3-4, 11-13; Hebrews 10:1-10.)

   b. How have you observed others offer their bodies as living sacrifices to God?

   c. In what way is God calling you to sacrificial living, and how are you responding?

Third Day: Reread Romans 12:1-2.

Paul called believers to be transformed by renewing their minds.

6. a. From Romans 12:2, what are believers to stop doing?

   b. Describe the pattern of this world. (See also Galatians 1:3-5; Ephesians 2:1-2; 1 John 2:15-17.)

7. a. From Romans 12:2, what are believers to do?

   b. How is a person transformed? (See also Romans 8:5-11; 2 Corinthians 3:18; Philippians 2:13.)

8. If you are a believer, how is God transforming you or proving that His will is good and pleasing? (See also 1 Peter 2:15; 3:17; 4:1-11.)

Fourth Day: Read Romans 12:3-5.

Paul described the unity and diversity of Christ's body, the Church.

9. What warning did Paul give, and why is it important?

10. a. To what did Paul compare Christians?

b. How does this illustration help you understand the way Christians are to relate to one another as the Church? (See also Ephesians 4:1-6.)

11. What is God revealing to you about how you view yourself and others?

Fifth Day: Read Romans 12:6-8.

Paul exhorted believers to serve God and others with their unique gifts.

12. Share truths concerning God's gifts to Christians from the following verses:

    1 Corinthians 7:7

    1 Corinthians 12:4-6

    Ephesians 4:11-13

    1 Peter 4:10-11

13. List the seven gifts in Romans 12:6-8 and how each should be exercised.

14. Which of the gifts has God given you? What opportunity has He given you to use His gifts in a local church?

Sixth Day: Review Romans 12:1-8.

God transforms and equips surrendered believers for the good of Christ's body.

15. How does humbly surrendering your life to the Lord impact your ability to live for Him and serve others?

Homiletics for Group and Administrative Leaders: Romans 12:1-8

Next step: Continue this lesson with group discussion, lecture, and notes.

Lecture Notes

Lesson 21 Notes

Romans 12:1-8

Focus Verse

"Therefore, I urge you, brothers and sisters, in view of God's mercy, to offer your bodies as a living sacrifice, holy and pleasing to God—this is your true and proper worship." (Romans 12:1)

Outline

- Wholehearted Worship – Romans 12:1-2
- Wholehearted Service – Romans 12:3-8

Engage

"The world exists to give me what I want." While few people openly state this view aloud, selfishness resides and hides in all people. Across cultures, this attitude takes different forms. Our schedules, jobs, families, successes, and pleasures drive us to justify such thoughts as, "Whatever satisfies me and my priorities matters most. Whatever I want to do is acceptable as long as my family's influence increases. I should prioritize my group's security and protection above all." Does the world exist to serve us and meet our needs? Are seemingly harmless choices ours to make? **The systems of this world are designed to provide people with what they feel they deserve.**

In contrast, Paul taught that God's will anchors all things. As Savior, Jesus rules all creation. Believers should live for God's priorities. God desires believers to live as Jesus did—for God's glory and the good of others. **God transforms and equips surrendered believers for the good of Christ's body.** People willing to wholeheartedly worship God and serve others discover that God's will for them brings personal satisfaction and eternal pleasure this fading world cannot offer.

In Romans 1–11, Paul laid the doctrinal foundation of God's saving righteousness. Then in Romans 12–16, Paul presented faith's transformative impact on our relationship with God and others. **God's righteousness is revealed as believers apply truths from Romans 1–11 to their daily lives.** These practices align with God's will in practical areas, which we will study over the next several lessons:

- Christian Worship and Service—12:1-8 (Lesson 21)
- Christian Love—12:9-21 (Lesson 22)
- Christian Submission to Authority—13:1-7 (Lesson 23)
- Christian Living—13:8-14 (Lesson 24)
- Christian Liberty—14 (Lesson 25)
- Christian Unity—15:1-13 (Lesson 26)
- Paul's Ministry and Plans—15:14-33 (Lesson 27)
- The Gospel's Impact in Rome and Corinth—16 (Lesson 28)

Wholehearted Worship – Romans 12:1-2

With the opening word "Therefore," Paul pointed back to his explanation about how God mercifully redeems sinners through Christ's death and resurrection. Secured through faith and eternal union with Christ, believers begin the journey of godly living. **Paul urged believers, who are indwelt by Christ's Spirit, to live differently than they did before their salvation.** Worship of the Lord should consume and propel believers' lives, "for from him and through him and for him are all things."[1]

Living Sacrifices – 12:1

***In View of God's Mercy* – Paul assumed that God's merciful salvation would inspire those He saved to live for Him.** God mercifully offers fallen humanity His righteousness, which they could never earn.[2] God also mercifully maintains a righteous plan for Israel's salvation through faith in their Messiah, Jesus.[3] Paul summarized God's mercy: "For God has bound everyone over to disobedience so that He may have mercy on them all."[4] Though God gave people over to their sinful desires,[5] His mercy makes salvation available by faith in Jesus.[6]

***Offer Your Bodies* –** Jesus has forever broken sin's power over believers. Paul previously commanded, "Count yourselves dead to sin but alive to God in Christ Jesus. Therefore do not let sin reign in your mortal body ... but rather offer yourselves to God."[7] **Sin still seeks to dominate believers through their bodies, but it cannot control people living for God's righteousness.**

***As Living Sacrifices* –** In the Old Testament, sacrificial animals[8] pointed toward Christ's once-for-all death for sin.[9] **Now, believers share in Jesus's death and resurrection by faith, living for Him and not themselves.[10]**

***Holy and Pleasing to God* – Paul described a believer's living sacrifice as holy, consecrated entirely to God.** Jesus held nothing back when He sacrificed himself for our redemption.[11] Consequently, Paul called believers to hold nothing back when they offer themselves to God. Holiness—a life set apart, reserved, and spent for God's glory—is a believer's identity and privilege.[12] Believers please God when they wholeheartedly offer themselves to Him.[13]

***Your True and Proper Worship* –** While Paul understood worship through Jewish laws and sacrificial customs, today's Christians might picture worship as an event or gathering for prayer, singing, and teaching. The New International Version (NIV) translates the Greek word *latreia* as "worship." This word conveys active service to God, who has reset our minds to think correctly and our hearts to worship rightly. The result? We glorify Him rather than His created things. The phrase "true and proper" traces back to a single Greek word, *logikos*, with meanings of spiritual, rational, or right reasoning. **Taken together, the words translated as "true and proper worship" explain that wholehearted Christian worship is service, which is reformed completely in our lives, spiritually and practically.**

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1. **Lord above all:** Romans 11:36a
2. **Mercy to humanity:** Romans 1–8
3. **Mercy to Israel:** Romans 9–11
4. **Mercy summarized:** Romans 11:32
5. **Gave them over:** Romans 1:18-32
6. **Salvation available:** Romans 10:13
7. **Bodies for God:** Romans 6:11-13
8. **Old Testament sacrifices:** Leviticus 16; Hebrews 10:1-10
9. **Once for all:** 1 Corinthians 5:7; Hebrews 9:28
10. **Living for Christ:** Romans 6:3-13; 2 Corinthians 5:15
11. **Jesus's sacrifice:** 1 Peter 1:18-19
12. **Holy people:** 1 Peter 2:9
13. **God's pleasure:** Matthew 25:21-23

Renewed Minds – 12:2

Negative Command – Living sacrifices that belong to God live for God alone. Paul wisely spoke truth to people of his day and ours: Do not let the time or age you live in mold your thinking and behavior to its schemes, standards, or values. **Paul called believers to think and act like Jesus Christ, rather than imitate the people in the world around them.**[14]

What worldly patterns might Paul have had in mind? Romans 1–11 reveals some patterns that concerned Paul: suppressing God's truth,[15] judgmentalism, self-righteousness,[16] misusing God's grace to excuse sin,[17] living to please the flesh,[18] works-based righteousness,[19] and rejecting the gospel.[20] **Each worldly pattern mentioned in Romans underscores our desperate need for righteousness only God can provide.**

The patterns of today's world still stem from humanity's fallen nature and inherited rebellion against God.[21] Many modern philosophies explain life apart from God:

- Secularism elevates the physical world as the center of all things.
- Humanism asserts that everything exists to please and glorify people.
- Relativism claims that there is no absolute truth, goodness, or beauty; each person must find their own truth.
- Materialism seeks meaning and value in wealth, health, and fame.
- Syncretism assumes that all religions are equally true, valuable, and valid.

Even without knowing the name or details of each philosophy, these ideas impact our families, economies, education, and social values.

Positive Command – Paul offered an alternative to conforming to the world's pattern—a renewed mind, which leads to transformed living. Paul called believers to a new worldview. People who think biblically live differently. **God makes believers increasingly like Jesus as they actively surrender their lives to Him.**[22]

A biblical worldview echoes Paul's doxology in Romans 11:33-36. **Renewed minds recognize God is eternally above and supremely beyond everything He created.** With God at the center, worship and surrender replace self-fulfillment and put all other allegiances in their rightful place. God determines the truths by which His creation operates. God has graciously revealed Himself to all people through creation,[23] the Scriptures,[24] and "his Son, whom he appointed heir of all things, and through whom also he made the universe."[25] In Jesus Christ, God illustrated goodness and beauty—humility, sacrificial love, and holiness.[26] In His wisdom, God ordained faith in the atoning sacrifice of Jesus Christ as the only way to receive His righteousness.[27] We can trust God's absolute truth.[28]

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14. **Like Christ:** Philippians 2:1-8
15. **Suppressing truth:** Romans 1
16. **Self-righteousness:** Romans 2
17. **Misusing grace:** Romans 6
18. **Pleasing flesh:** Romans 8
19. **Works-based righteousness:** Romans 9
20. **Rejecting Christ:** Romans 10
21. **World's pattern:** Galatians 1:3-5; Ephesians 2:1-2; 1 John 2:15-17
22. **God's work:** Matthew 11:29; John 3:30; Romans 8:5-11; 2 Corinthians 3:18; Ephesians 4:17-24; Philippians 2:12-13; Colossians 3:1-17
23. **Creation's witness:** Psalm 19:1; Romans 1:18-20
24. **God revealed in Scripture:** Romans 15:4; Hebrews 1:1
25. **God revealed in Christ:** Hebrews 1:2-3
26. **Christ's humility and sacrifice:** Isaiah 53
27. **Jesus the way:** John 14:6
28. **God is trustworthy:** Numbers 23:19; John 14:6, 16-17; 16:13; 17:17

The Result – God transforms believers by renewing their minds. People cannot transform themselves; however, Christian transformation is not a passive process. God provides daily opportunities for believers to apply His wisdom and prove His way and will are good and perfect. Saving faith believes God and acts on that belief. **When believers consciously and deliberately obey God, they experience that His will is best.**[29] Paul offered this encouragement to believers learning to live for God: "The mind governed by the Spirit is life and peace."[30]

Wholehearted Service – Romans 12:3-8

As God renews believers' minds, their views of God, self, and others are transformed. After urging believers to surrender their bodies and minds to the Lord, Paul addressed how God calls believers to think and live in relationship with one another. **Surrendered believers serve for God's glory and to benefit His redeemed family.** Paul also taught that transformed believers impact the world outside the Christian community. As part of their true and proper worship, they look outward toward God and others and not to themselves. We will study this in detail in future lessons.

Unified Body – 12:3-5

New life in Christ reconciles believers with God and His family, which includes relationships with all God's children.[31] **Christ unites believers as members of His body.**

Thinking of Yourself (12:3) – Paul demonstrated for his readers the importance of sober self-assessment as he stated, "For by the grace given me I say to every one of you." **Paul did not think of himself more highly than appropriate; God's grace alone validated Paul's message.** In his letter to Timothy, Paul called himself the worst of sinners.[32] He understood who he was apart from God's mercy in Christ Jesus.[33] Paul also knew that through Jesus and for Christ's sake, he "received grace and apostleship to call all the Gentiles to the obedience that comes from faith."[34] Paul humbly exercised his God-given authority, calling, and gifting as he served and taught God's people.

Building on his example, Paul exhorted believers to behave as new creations in Christ,[35] thinking of themselves with "sober judgment, in accordance with the faith God has distributed." Sober thinking is faith-filled thinking grounded in truth. **Knowing that new life in Christ is God's gracious gift helps Christians avoid proudly elevating themselves or being trapped in shame.** While no one is righteous apart from God, God also made people in His image, blessed them, and entrusted His creation to their care.[36] Believers are God's handiwork.[37] In Christ, God's eternal spiritual blessings are theirs.[38]

Therefore, rather than think of themselves too highly or too often, believers are called to think "in accordance with the faith God has distributed." How should we understand faith in this phrase?

- Faith may refer to confidence in God. We align our view of self with our knowledge of God and trust in Him. Scripture teaches us how to view God, ourselves, and others.

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29. **God's will:** 1 Peter 2:15; 3:17; 4:11
30. **Life and peace:** Romans 8:6
31. **God's family:** Romans 8:12-17
32. **Worst sinner:** 1 Timothy 1:15-16
33. **All under sin:** Romans 3:9
34. **Paul's apostleship:** Romans 1:5
35. **New creations:** 2 Corinthians 5:17
36. **God's image:** Genesis 1:26-28
37. **God's handiwork:** Ephesians 2:10
38. **Spiritual blessings:** Ephesians 1:3-10

- Faith may refer to believing God has entrusted people with gifts, talents, and opportunities intended for His glory. Because Paul's letter goes on to discuss spiritual gifts, this meaning, though unusual, may fit best with Paul's intent.

***Thinking of Others (12:4-5)* – Paul explained how believers should think about and relate to one another by comparing the Church to a human body: "one body with many members, and these members do not all have the same function."** Paul's powerful word picture establishes the basis for Christian unity. A human body cannot function without diverse parts. In the same way, believers with different functions together make up Christ's body. This image helps believers understand that each one has a unique and essential function within the body of Christ. How believers connect to one another in the body and contribute to the body matters.

Continuing with the theme of unity, Paul taught, "So in Christ we, though many, form one body, and each member belongs to all the others." The book of Acts unfolds the story of how God united believing Jews and Gentiles into one faith community. The two groups learned how to find unity in Christ's cross rather than in religious laws and traditions.[39] Jews and Gentiles, former enemies united by Christ, had to learn to think differently about one another.[40] **Paul asserted that diverse believers do more than tolerate one another's differences; Christian belonging involves mutual acceptance and humble service.** God unites believers to Jesus and one another through the Holy Spirit. Every person who places their faith in Christ experiences an invisible but real spiritual union with Jesus[41] and fellow believers.[42]

Chapter 4 of Paul's letter to the Ephesians parallels Romans 12. In both passages, Paul referred to the body of Christ as he applied doctrinal teaching to Christian living. In Ephesians 4:4-6, Paul said of the Church, "There is one body and one Spirit, just as you were called to one hope when you were called; one Lord, one faith, one baptism; one God and Father of all, who is over all and through all and in all."[43] **This passage highlights several ways believers are united.** First, all Christians are joined by the Holy Spirit into one body, sharing the same hope for eternity. Next, they share one Lord, one faith, and one baptism, working together to serve Christ and spread the gospel. Finally, the Church belongs to one God—the Father—who created it and brings people together to live for His glory and purpose.

Diverse Gifts – 12:6-8

Paul's illustration of the body points to diversity within the Church's unity. God saves individuals from various cultures and backgrounds, then gives them unique gifts to exercise in diverse settings. Each believer assumes responsibility for the gifts God has given them, not for the gifts God has given others. While the world promotes competing to surpass one another, God calls His people to receive and exercise His gracious gifts to wholeheartedly serve and bless others.

***Prophesying (12:6)* –** Paul stated, "We have different gifts." The Greek word *charismata*, meaning "gifts," relates to *charis,* meaning "grace." Grace is God's unmerited favor, so *charismata* are undeserved gifts of God's grace. **Believers' gifts differ because God gives spiritual gifts according to His purpose and pleasure.[44]** Five New Testament passages list 20 different gifts.[45] Each believer has at least one gift and honors God when exercising His gifts for the well-being of the whole body.[46]

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39. **Early Church unity:** Acts 10:44–11:18; 15:1-31
40. **Jew and Gentile:** Romans 11:17-24
41. **Union with Jesus:** Romans 6:3-10
42. **Christian unity:** John 17:23; Romans 15:5-6
43. **One body:** Ephesians 4:1-6
44. **Different gifts:** 1 Corinthians 12:4-6
45. **Gifts listed:** Romans 12:6-8; 1 Corinthians 12:8-10, 28-30; Ephesians 4:11-13; 1 Peter 4:10-11
46. **Each gifted:** 1 Corinthians 7:7

Christ's Unified Body

The Doctrine of the Church

Paul taught that in Jesus diverse believers form one body. This helps us understand that there is one Church, the Church universal or invisible. **Christ's Church, present in local congregations, includes every born-again believer.** Being a part of Christ's Church is defined by internal union with Christ Himself rather than external association with an organization. The individual believers who comprise the worldwide community of Christ's body represent the diverse nature of God's creation and the gospel's global reach. The Church's diverse languages, cultures, spiritual gifts, and organizational structures punctuate Paul's teaching that God's saving grace is available to all who call on Jesus as Lord.

When God poured out the Holy Spirit at Pentecost, Christ's Church was born.[1] **Christ reigns as the head of the Church—His body.**[2] Born-again believers demonstrate Christ's love and saving power. His saving grace merits loving surrender and wholehearted worship from His Church. Jesus promised to build His Church and that the gates of hell would not prevail against it.[3] Jesus fulfills this promise as the gospel spreads and believers express loving unity and sacrificial service.

Paul's emphatic call to Christian unity and interdependence underscores the importance of the Church. When we do not believe that Christ's Church is a global, diverse body of believers, we live isolated from the spiritual gifts God gives the Church for the good of all. We might be tempted to exchange the global wonder of God's saving work for familiar traditions. We miss opportunities to be enriched by diversity today while we await Christ's return.[4]

When we embrace the worldwide community of believers in Christ's Church, God's multifaceted beauty becomes visible in each unique member of Christ's body. Fellowship with believers becomes essential to our growth, faith, and steadfast walk in the Lord. **People worship Christ when they use their gifts to strengthen His Church, both around the world and in their own local communities.** The Holy Spirit unites believers around the world to worship the Lord and serve His family.

1. **Pentecost:** Acts 2:1-11, 36-41
2. **Jesus the head:** Colossians 1:18
3. **Build His Church:** Matthew 16:18
4. **Heaven's diversity:** Revelation 5:9-10; 21:24-26

Paul mentioned prophesying first in his list of gifts in Romans 12. To prophesy means to proclaim, or "forthtell," a message. In both the Old and New Testaments, true prophets spoke God's words. Some prophets spoke about the future (foretelling). Paul also taught about prophecy in 1 Corinthians 14. He described prophets speaking under the Holy Spirit's influence to communicate God's revealed truth, remind people of a duty, or give a warning.[47] In the sense of new revelation from God—words to be included in the Word of God, the biblical canon—the gift of prophecy is no

47. Prophecy's use: Acts 21:10-14; 1 Corinthians 14:1-5

longer with the Church. **Today, the completed Old and New Testaments comprise God's perfect, inspired, living revelation, offering the only complete and authoritative guide for faith, doctrine, and life.** With the phrase, "prophesy in accordance with your faith," Paul may have been exhorting prophets to speak in alignment with the gospel of Jesus Christ.[48] Faithful Christians have varied views about how to understand the operation of prophecy in the Church today. Regardless of perspective, any prophetic message should be carefully weighed and tested against Scripture.[49]

Serving and Teaching (12:7) – The Greek word translated as "serving" is *diakonia*. While this word might refer to the specific office of deacon or diaconal (service) ministry,[50] God calls all of us to serve others in the Church. Some receive this gift in special measure to lead others in serving. **Jesus expressed His heart for serving: "The Son of Man did not come to be served, but to serve, and to give his life as a ransom for many."[51]** Paul instructed believers to follow Jesus's example.

The teaching gift appears in all five New Testament lists of spiritual gifts. God often equips pastors with a strong teaching gift. However, everyone who knows Jesus and the gospel can teach others. **Believers can teach what they know of Christ through conversations and personal testimony.** Paul called for action. Be faithful in teaching, if that is your gift, but remember that every Christian has opportunities to share truth with others.

Encouraging, Giving, Leading, and Showing Mercy (12:8) – The Bible strongly associates encouragement with the ministry of the Holy Spirit—the believer's advocate.[52] English translations of the Greek word, *parakletos*, include helper, advocate, lawyer, encourager, consoler, intercessor, and mediator. **Encouraging expresses the idea of coming alongside someone to advise and support.** Paul called the encourager to offer more than upbeat expressions like "Good job!" or "Cheer up!" but to build others up with fortifying truth.

The gift of giving extends beyond an official church offering. Paul urged people with this gift to give "generously." **God calls all believers to give generously from the funds and resources entrusted to them.** Paul would have likely instructed church officers to give wisely or prayerfully, considering they handle the money of others.

Leadership includes management, government, and administration. Church elders especially need to manage and take care of God's church.[53] **Those called into church leadership need the essential spiritual gift of leadership in order to seek and protect the well-being of God's people.**

Finally, Paul listed the gift of showing mercy. Through the Holy Spirit, God gifts believers to show His mercy "cheerfully," not resentfully or judgmentally. **Believers show mercy to others in grateful, humble response to the mercy they have received from God.**

By His grace, God equips all believers with compassion, forgiveness, and diverse gifts to serve the needs of others in His Church. **God transforms and equips surrendered believers for the good of Christ's body.**

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48. Prophets and truth: Jude 1:3
49. Weigh and test: 1 Corinthians 14:29; 1 Thessalonians 5:20-21
50. Deacons: Acts 6:1-6
51. Jesus served: Matthew 20:28
52. Advocate: John 14:16, 26; 15:26; 16:7
53. Church elders: 1 Timothy 3:1-7

Take to Heart

Hold Fast

With God's mercy in view, Paul urged believers to let the gospel change every part of their lives. **God's merciful salvation calls for wholehearted surrender to Him and His ways.** True worship means living for the Lord, rejecting this world's patterns, being transformed from within by God, and looking outward to the flourishing of other people. Transformation begins with a renewed mind and active surrender to God's good, pleasing, and perfect will.

As believers renew their minds, they think differently about God, His creation, self, and others. Paul challenged believers to view relationships with one another as essential to living a new life in Christ. **Believers live for God and others in the interconnected community of Christ's body—the Church.** Each member of Christ's Church has gifts that God intends for the good of the whole body. Paul called believers to embrace their gifts and serve others wholeheartedly.

Apply It

What would your life be like apart from God's mercy? Some people are flooded with gratitude for God's mercy as they consider sin's devastating impact in their lives. Perhaps those saved at a young age or long ago struggle to imagine life apart from God's mercy. Without understanding God's mercy, we lack motivation for sacrificial living that opposes the world's pattern. **How we view God and His mercy impacts our perspective on everything else.** If God's mercy toward you in Christ has not yet gripped your heart, look back at Romans 1–11. Will you ask God for a fresh understanding of your desperate need for a Savior and His powerful provision of Jesus? Through faith in Jesus, God mercifully provides righteousness we do not deserve, could never earn, and can never lose.

What might be lost if you began to think and live differently than the world? **Do you fear alienation from friends and loved ones if you no longer conform to the patterns that drive their lives?** God's will for people is always good. He desires people to know Him and flourish in relationship with Christ's Church. If you have not placed your faith in Jesus Christ for salvation from sin and death, God's will is for you to turn to Him. Trust Him today. If you are already saved by faith, consider how God's transforming work in you can shine His light and love to others. As you renew your mind and live for Christ, God will change you. As a growing gospel ambassador, you can offer suffering people hope in God's love and Christ's saving power.

When have you forgotten God's grace and taken credit for your gifts? When a skill or talent comes easily, pride tempts us to rely on our own efforts and believe we are better than others. If we think our spiritual gifts depend on us, we become discouraged when our gifts do not measure up to other people's gifts. **Unlike human merit, status, or achievement, our salvation and spiritual gifts come by God's grace.** Our loving heavenly Father freely gives spiritual gifts to all His children. If you have placed your faith in Jesus, gratefully rejoice in God's gracious gifts to you. Look for and celebrate the diverse gifts He has given to your fellow believers. If you haven't yet trusted Jesus as your Savior, will you trust Him today? Salvation is yours for the asking. The Lord loves showering His spiritual gifts upon His children. The world cannot compete with the delight of watching God's creative work through the members of Christ's body.

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